

Spin Chains I Simulated, Talks I Half Understood, and Other Honest Moments from a Year Wandering Through Science Events

Abhishek Karna¹

¹ Karsh International Scholarship, Office of University Scholars and Fellows, Duke University, Durham, NC, USA

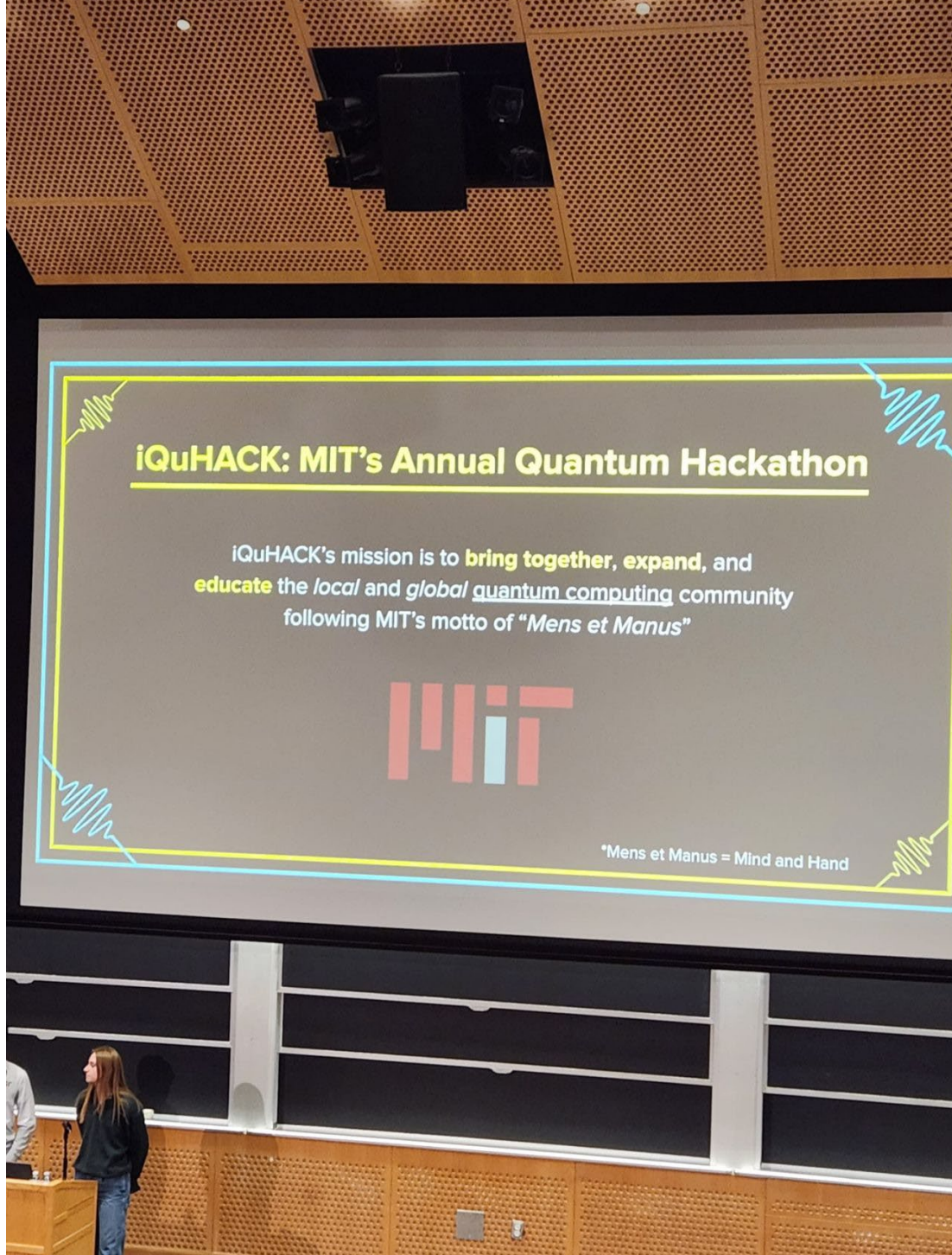
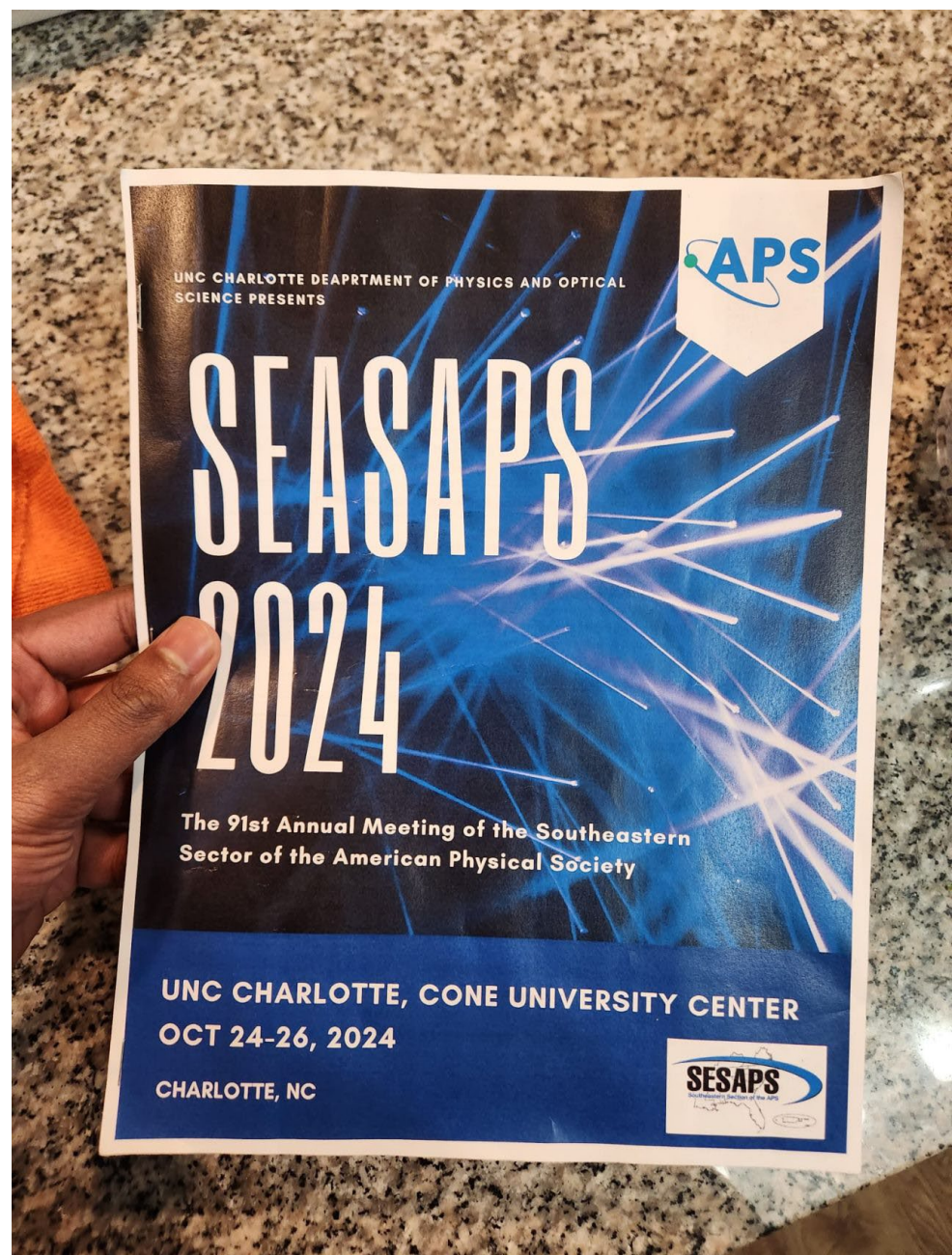
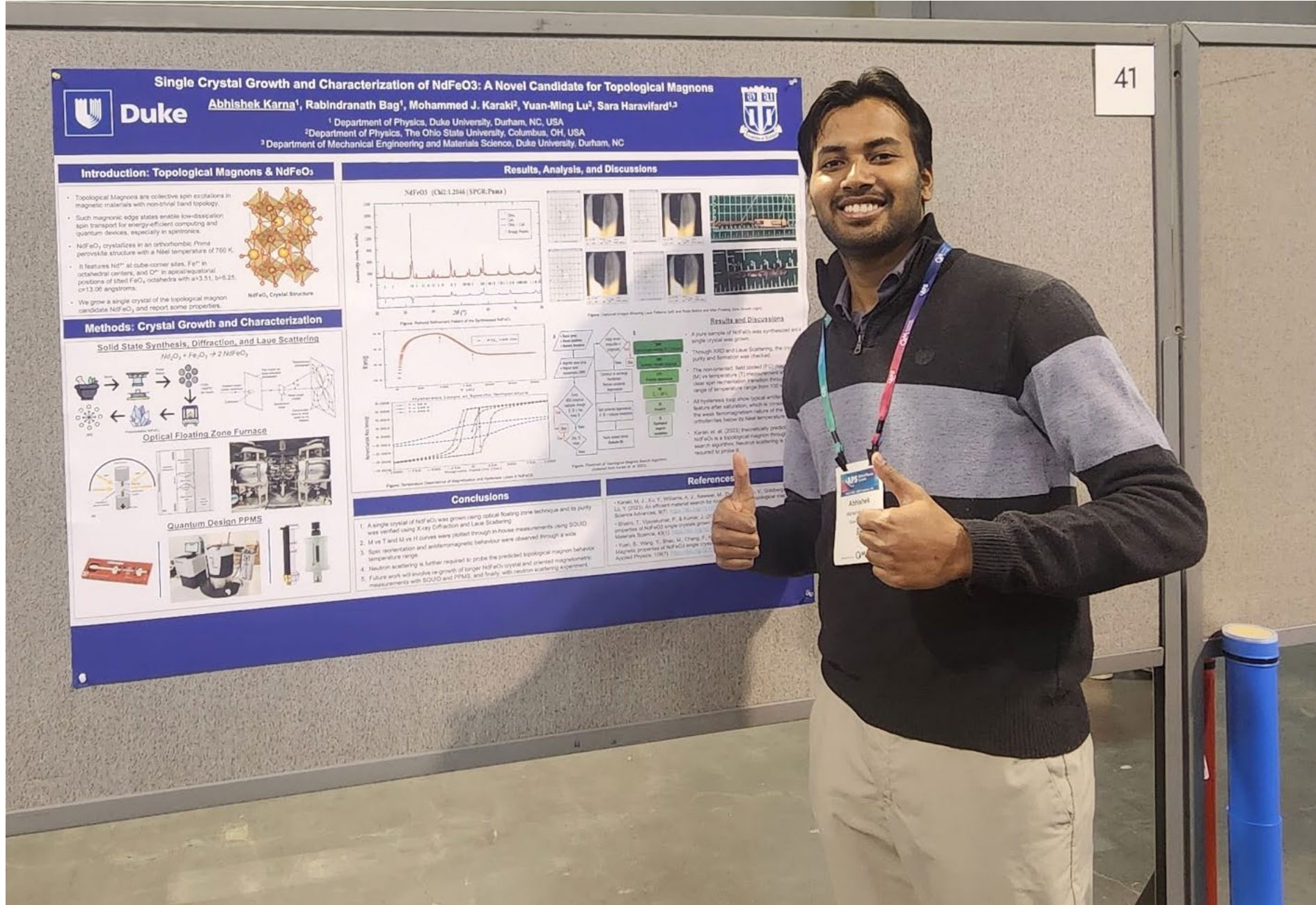
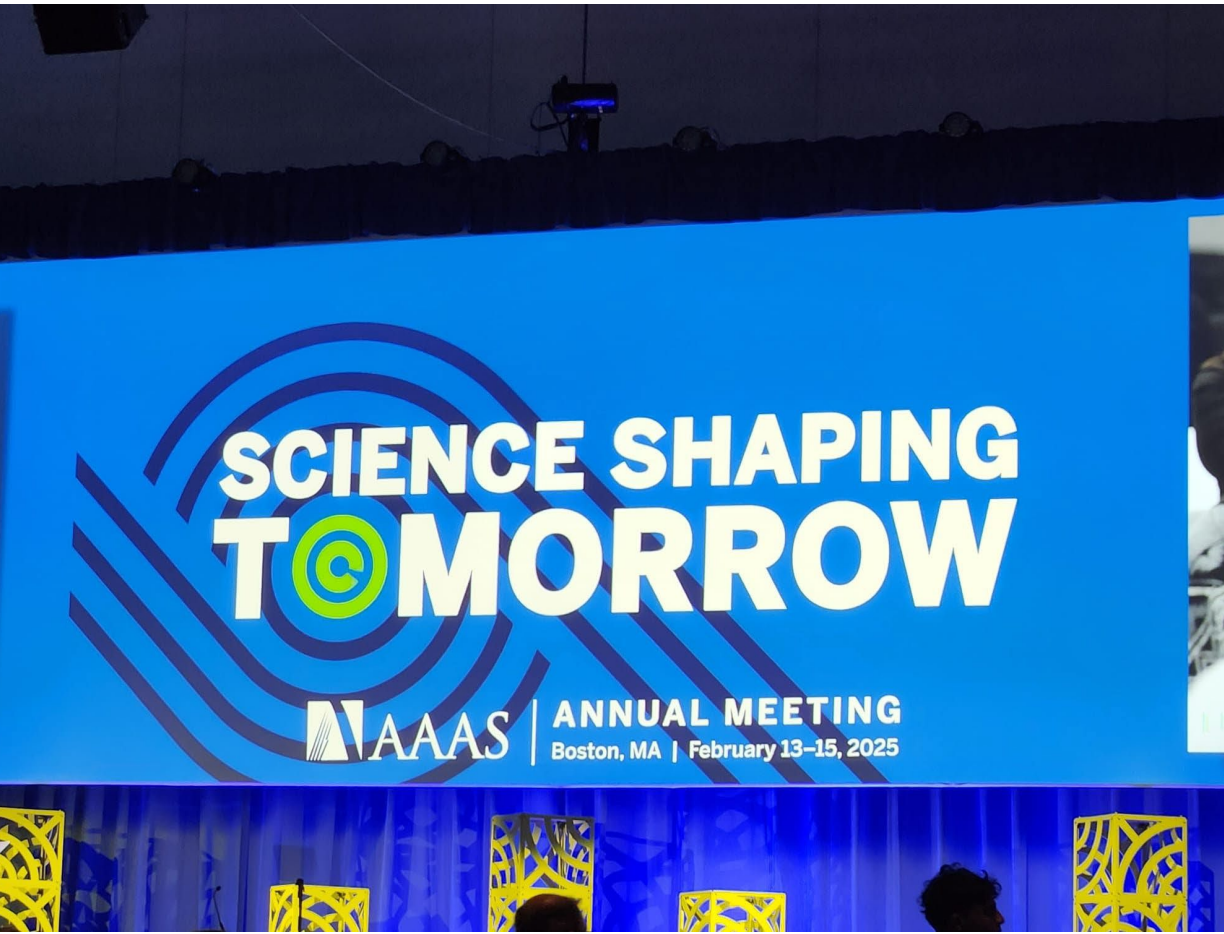
Four Nerdy Adventures and What I Got Out of Them

- Attended four major science events across the U.S.—two physics conferences, one interdisciplinary meeting, and one quantum hackathon.
- Engaged with topics ranging from quantum spin chains and dark matter to altermagnetism and AI policy.
- Presented my research on NdFeO_3 single crystals and their potential for topological magnon excitations.
- Won 1st prize at the MIT iQuHack, one of largest Quantum Computing Hackathon in the world.



Planes, Badges, and Note-Taking

- Traveled to Boston (AAAS), Anaheim (APS), Charlotte (SEAPS), and Cambridge (MIT iQuHack) using enrichment funds.
- Presented a research poster, joined a winning hackathon team, and attended high-profile lectures by top scientists.



Talking points...

- Witnessed lectures on simulating quantum gravity, uncertainty visualization, ultracold atoms, and more.
- Saw demos from Boston Dynamics, viewed new quantum circuit designs, and toured massive poster halls.
- Highlight: Juan Maldacena explaining AdS/CFT like it was no big deal—took me three days to recover.
- Captured moments of insight, confusion, and awe across disciplines, from particle physics to science policy.

What the Smart People Said (and What I Think They Meant)

- Quantum computing is cool, but error correction is still a nightmare.
- Altermagnetism is everywhere now—it's not just a buzzword.
- Physics conferences love acronyms; hackathons love food.
- Everyone agrees we need to better communicate science—but no one agrees on how.

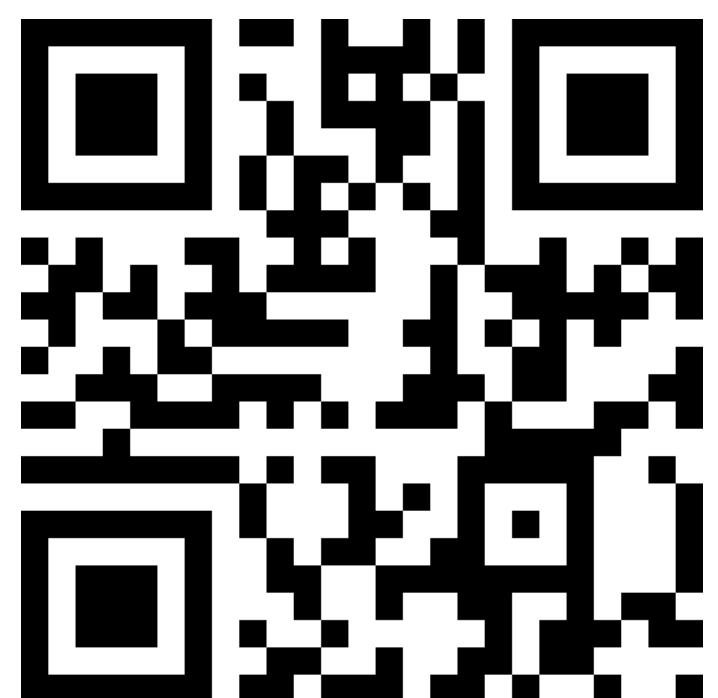
Lessons, Laughs, and a Long List of People to Google Later

- Science moves fast, but curiosity moves faster.
- Interdisciplinary conversations spark unexpected ideas (and confusion).
- Winning a hackathon feels great; explaining your code at 3 a.m. to judges feels even better (kind of).
- I left with more questions than answers—which is exactly how it should be.
- Policy talks made me realize that physics doesn't exist in a vacuum—even if your experiment does.

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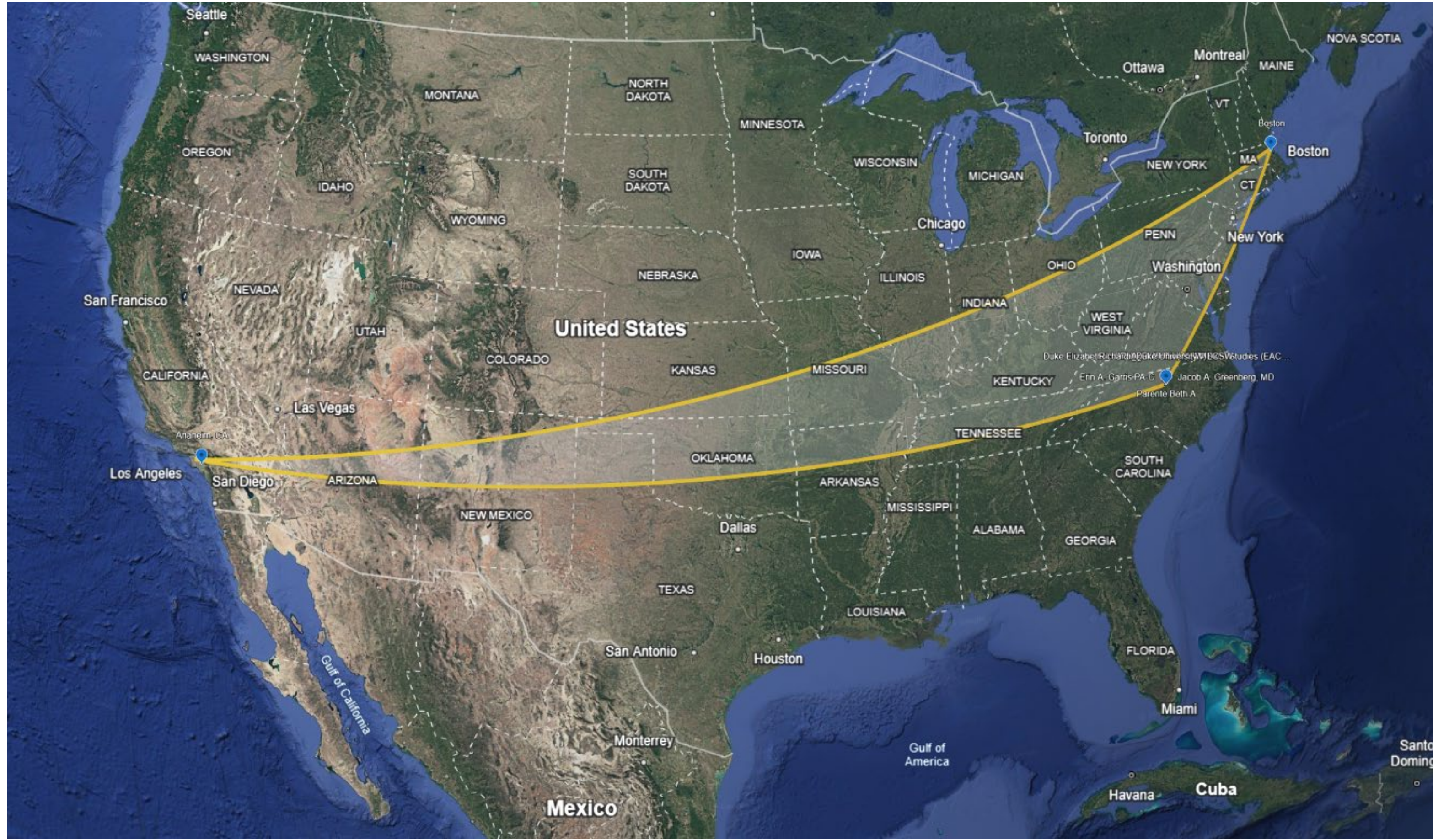
APS Global Physics Summit



AAAS Annual Meeting



More? Check my LinkedIn...



Representative image of locations visited during the experiences: Durham, Boston, Anaheim

- Networked with researchers, students, and policy experts across disciplines and institutions.
- Took messy notes, asked odd questions, and drank a statistically significant amount of conference coffee.